

First-Half Assessment — Jesús Luzardo (LHP), 2026 All-Star

Phillies Pitching · 19 starts · 2026-03-29 through 2026-07-09 · First career All-Star selection

Prepared for: manager / pitching department / Luzardo / catcher — first-half review **Throws:** L · **Arsenal:** 4 pitches (Sweeper, 4-Seam, Changeup, Sinker — the slider is retired) **Governance:** Use Case #19 (uc-pps-017) · locked KPIs inherited verbatim from Baseball Functions via dp_uc11 · seven NEW derived KPIs (PD-1..PD-7) spec'd in 02_engineering_design.md, provisional pending DPO ratification · pps mirror of the Marsh breakout retrospective (UC #18)

△ **Read this first — data window & sample sizes.** • Source: phils_2025 + phils_2026 parquet, entity-locked to pitcher == 666200, regular season only, deduped. 2026 cache fresh through **2026-07-12**; Luzardo's last start 2026-07-09. • 2026 = **first half only** (19 starts, 465 PA). 2025 = **full season** (32 starts, 759 PA). Season-shape comparisons carry that asymmetry. • July 2026 split = **49 PA**. Marchán battery split = **70 PA**. Both below the 100-BF convention — directional only, PA printed everywhere they appear. • **IP is reconstructed from event outs** (may differ ~1 out from official). **Runs = runs scored while he was on the mound** (RA9, not earned-run accounting — official ERA is not computed here). • The All-Star selection itself is a **user-provided carry-in**, logged in the freshness manifest. • §6 persona narratives are *inference consistent with the data*, labeled as such — not observed fact.

Bottom line

1. **The workload is the first-order All-Star case: 108.2 IP over 19 starts (5.2 IP/start, ~97 pitches/start), never missing a turn, with a 3.64 RA9 and 2.84 FIP.** Nineteen starts of rotation-anchor volume with a strikeout per inning (136 K, 29.2 K%) is the resume.
 2. **The results line is a continuation of 2025; the process line is a step change.** wOBA against is flat (.289 → .295) but xwOBA against dropped .292 → **.269**, hard-hit rate fell **37.1% → 30.5%**, and whiff rate rose 30.8% → 32.5%. The 2026 gap (wOBA .295 vs xwOBA .269) says the results have been slightly worse than the contact quality deserved — that's a sustainability argument, not a luck warning.
 3. **The engine is an arsenal redesign: the sweeper became the primary pitch (31% → 37%) and now runs a 50.9% whiff rate (.193 xwOBA against); the slider is gone; the sinker nearly doubled (10% → 17%); the 4-seam, down to 25% usage, gained velocity (96.5 → 97.1) and cut its xwOBA .364 → .312.** Less fastball, better fastball.
 4. **He closed the half on a surge that made the selection: over the last 4 starts (6/23-7/9), 39 K in 99 PA with start xwOBAs of .229 / .255 / .135 / .192, and a July line of .175 wOBA / .164 xwOBA / 40.8 K% (49 PA — small, but it's the recency the voters saw).**
 5. **The watch item is the second time through the order: 1st TTO is elite (.198 wOBA, 0 HR, 172 PA) but 2nd TTO is .368 (171 PA) — an inversion of 2025, when he was steady across all three.** The half worked partly because the leash was managed around it; the second half should be too.
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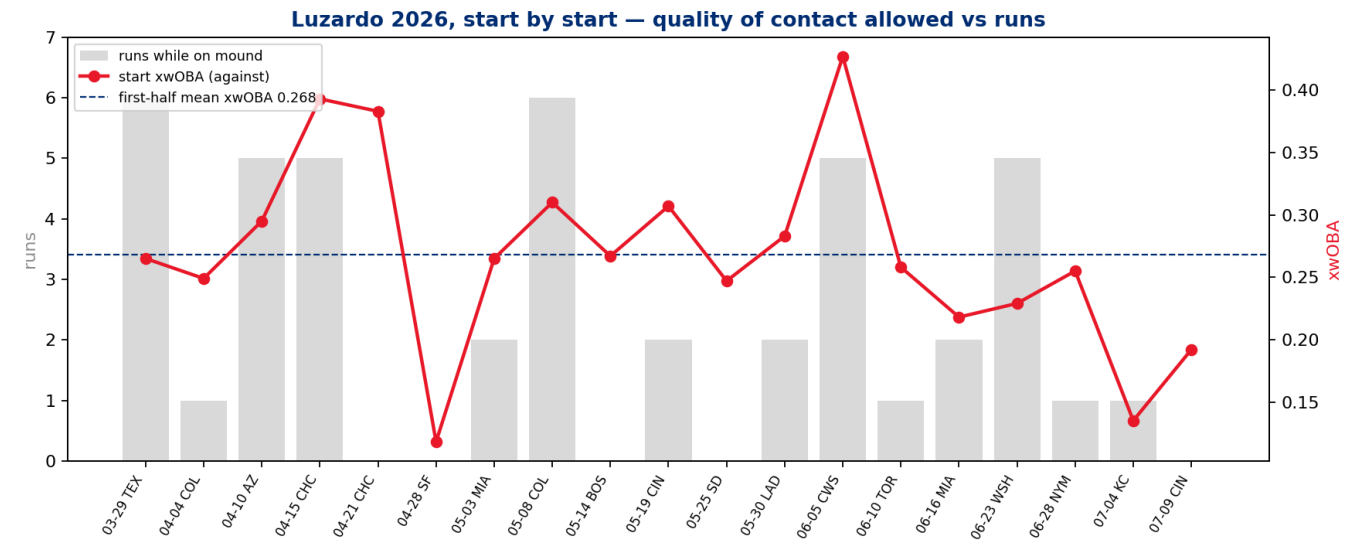
§1 — The results first (outcomes, 2026 first half vs 2025)

	2025 (full)	2026 (first half)
Starts / IP	32 / 179.1	19 / 108.2
PA / K% / BB%	759 / 28.5% / 7.5%	465 / 29.2% / 7.5%
wOBA / xwOBA against	.289 / .292	.295 / .269
HR (per PA)	16 (.021)	9 (.019)
Hard-hit %	37.1%	30.5%
RA9 / FIP	3.76 / 2.89	3.64 / 2.84

Receipts: dp_uc17_luzardo_season_line.csv, dp_uc17_luzardo_season_xwoba.csv, dp_uc17_luzardo_process_kpis_yoy.csv.

Staff context (2026, ≥500 pitches): Luzardo's .269 xwOBA against is second among Phillies starters (Wheeler .254; Sánchez .279; Nola .318; Painter .348), and his **33.1% CSW leads the rotation** (Sánchez 32.7%, Wheeler 29.2%). Receipt: dp_uc17_staff_benchmark_2026.csv.

Start-by-start (receipt: dp_uc17_luzardo_start_log_2026.csv, fig 2): 19 starts, all between 86 and 106 pitches. Three blow-ups (3/29 TEX 6 runs, 5/8 COL 3 IP / 6 runs, 6/5 CWS .427 xwOBA) against seven starts of ≤1 run — the floor was rocky in April, the ceiling showed up from late April on, and the last month was the best pitching of his Phillies tenure.



§2 — The surge that timed the nod (monthly, 2026)

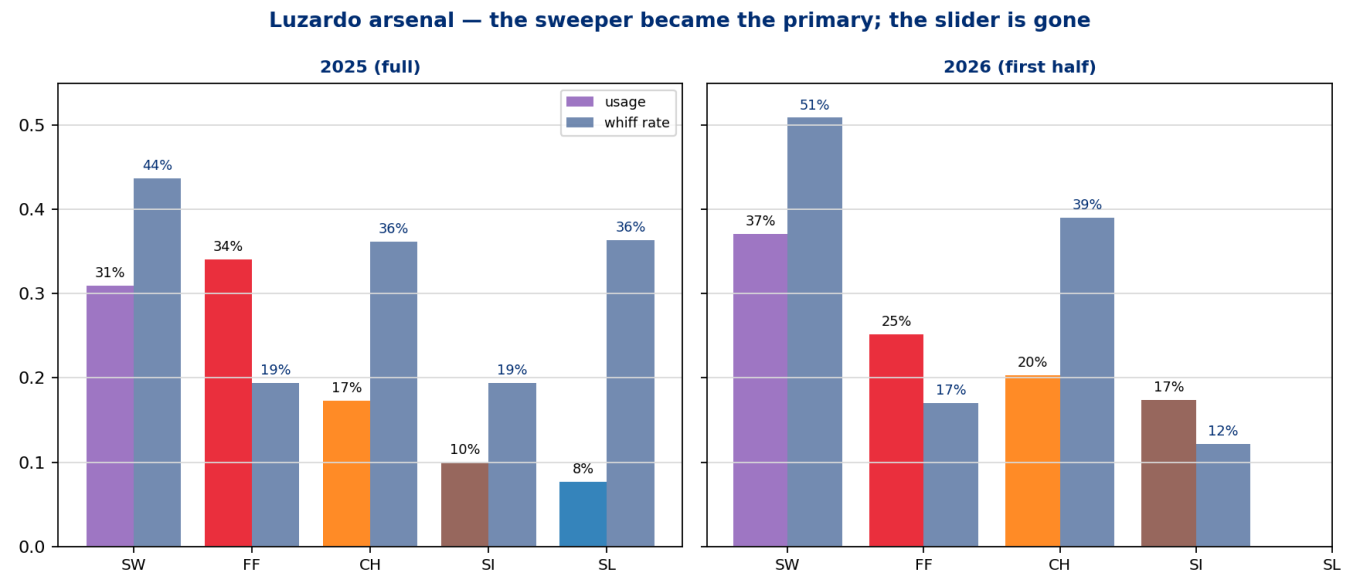
Month	PA	wOBA	xwOBA	K%	CSW
Mar/Apr	146	.303	.287	28.1%	33.0%
May	140	.322	.278	26.4%	30.9%
June	130	.303	.278	29.2%	34.3%
July	49	.175	.164	40.8%	36.6%

(Mar+Apr pooled from the monthly receipt; July is 49 PA — directional.) The expected line was steady all half (~.278-.287) while results wobbled; July is when results caught down to process. Receipt: dp_uc17_luzardo_monthly_2026.csv.

§3 — Driver 1: the arsenal redesign

Pitch	Usage 25→26	Velo 25→26	Whiff 25→26	xwOBA 25→26
Sweeper	31.0% → 37.1%	86.1 → 86.4	43.7% → 50.9%	.199 → .193
4-Seam	34.1% → 25.2%	96.5 → 97.1	19.4% → 17.0%	.364 → .312
Changeup	17.3% → 20.3%	87.9 → 86.2	36.2% → 39.0%	.292 → .284
Sinker	10.0% → 17.4%	95.8 → 96.0	19.4% → 12.2%	.370 → .323
Slider	7.7% → retired	—	—	—

Receipt: dp_uc17_luzardo_arsenal_yoy.csv, fig 1. Three deliberate-looking moves: (a) the two breaking balls were consolidated into one sweeper thrown more and missing more bats; (b) fastball usage was cut 9 points while the pitch itself got harder and better; (c) the sinker took over east-west duty against RHB. The sweeper's 2-strike putaway (29.9%) is the strikeout engine.



§4 — Driver 2: a chase-led process identity

KPI	2025	2026
First-pitch strike	67.2%	60.0%
In-zone rate	50.5%	46.8%
Chase rate	30.4%	33.3%
Whiff rate	30.8%	32.5%
CSW	31.8%	33.1%
2-strike putaway	22.1%	24.1%
Hard-hit %	37.1%	30.5%

Receipt: `dp_uc17_luzardo_process_kpis_yoy.csv`. He is throwing *fewer* strikes — first-pitch strike rate down 7 points, zone rate down 3.7 — and getting *better* results, because hitters are chasing 3 points more and missing more when they swing. Crucially the walk rate did not move (7.5% both years): the out-of-zone pitching is bought back by chase, not paid for in walks. That trade holds only as long as the sweeper stays this deceptive — flagged in §7.

Count leverage receipt (`dp_uc17_luzardo_count_leverage_yoy.csv`) agrees: fewer pitches ahead in the count (32.2% → 27.9%), similar share of PA reaching two strikes (57.4% → 56.3%), better conversion once there.

§5 — The splits: where the results and the process disagree

By stand (receipt: `dp_uc17_luzardo_by_stand_yoy.csv`):

Split	PA	wOBA	xwOBA
vs LHB 2026	112	.209	.212
vs RHB 2026	353	.323	.287
vs RHB 2025	586	.307	.314

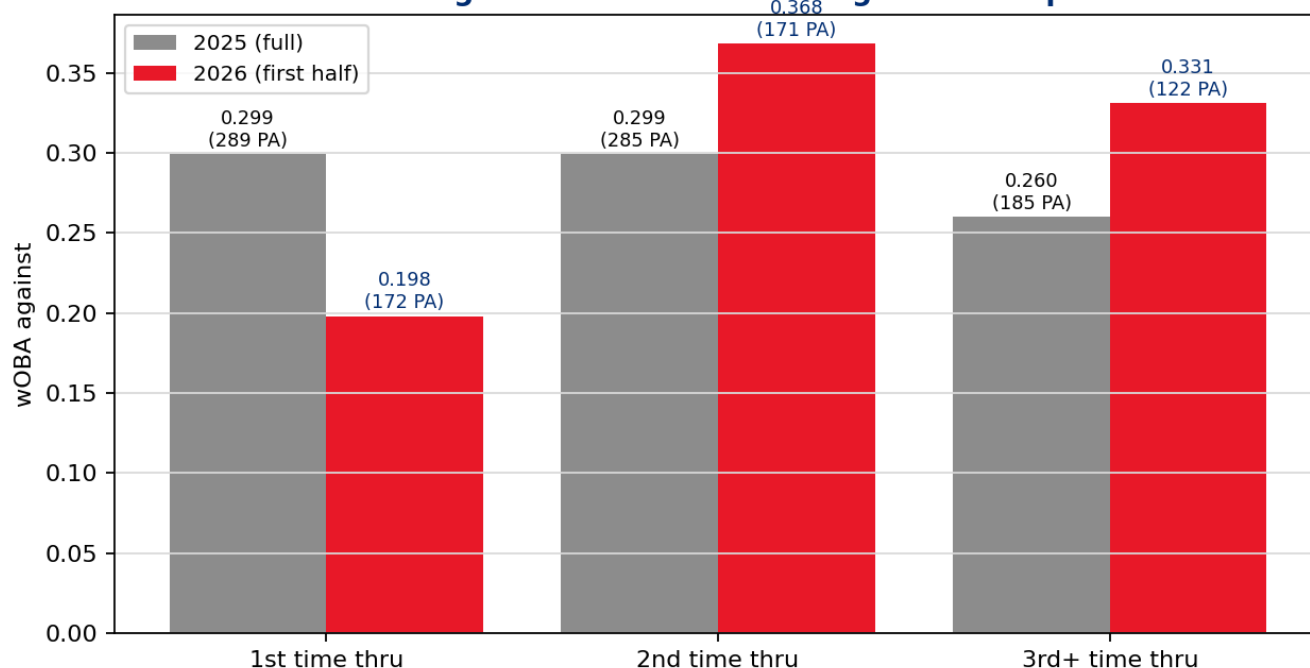
Lefties are a wipeout (sweeper-driven, results and process agree). Against righties the results line *worsened* (.307 → .323) while the expected line *improved* (.314 → .287) — the RHB results gap is loud but the process gap is silent; don't over-read it. He is fine against RHB; the ball just found grass in the first half.

Times through the order (receipt: `dp_uc17_luzardo_tto_yoy.csv`, fig 3):

TTO	2025 wOBA (PA)	2026 wOBA (PA)
1st	.299 (289)	.198 (172) — 0 HR
2nd	.299 (285)	.368 (171)
3rd+	.260 (185)	.331 (122)

2026 inverted his 2025 shape: the first look is now nearly unhittable and the second look is the danger zone. All 9 HR allowed came 2nd time through or later.

Times through the order — the manager's leash question



Battery (receipt: [dp_uc17_luzardo_battery_2026.csv](#)): Realmuto caught 1,549 of 1,836 pitches (.310 wOBA / .277 xwOBA, 34.2% chase, 25.0% putaway); Marchán's 287-pitch, **70-PA** sample (.211 wOBA / .224 xwOBA) is directional only. The chase-led identity in §4 runs through Realmuto's game-calling — that attribution is inference (see §6), but the volume is his.

§6 — Persona actions: who did what, and what to do next

Everything in this section is inference consistent with the data — plausible attribution, not observed fact. Each claim points at its indicator.

Pitching department

Retrospective credit: the arsenal redesign (§3) has the fingerprints of a deliberate offseason/spring plan — a pitch retired, the breaking-ball share consolidated into the sweeper, fastball usage cut while its velocity rose. That set of changes is what a pitching-dept pitch-design cycle produces; it is the single largest driver of the whiff and hard-hit gains. **Second-half watch:** the sinker earns its 17% usage on contact management, not swing-and-miss (12.2% whiff, .323 xwOBA — worst pitch in the bag). Re-evaluate its share vs RHB before assuming the RHB xwOBA gain is arsenal-driven rather than sequencing-driven.

Catcher (Realmuto)

Retrospective credit: the chase-led identity (§4) is executed at the game-calling level — zone rate down 3.7 points with zero walk-rate cost, CSW up to a rotation-best 33.1%, and 2-strike putaway up 2 points behind heavier 2-strike sweeper usage. **Second-half watch:** protect the putaway edge — if chase regresses toward 2025 levels, the 60% first-pitch strike rate stops being affordable. The Marchán split (70 PA) is not evidence for a battery change in either direction; don't let it become one.

Manager

Retrospective credit: the leash was consistent and protective — every start between 86 and 106 pitches, 5.2 IP/start average, no skipped turns. Given the 2nd-TTO cliff (.368), keeping starts in the 5–7 IP band is part of why the season line held. **Second-half watch:** the hook decision now has a number — the danger window opens the second time through (all 9 HR came TTO 2+). Against RHB-heavy lineups, batters 19–27 are where the bridge reliever earns his roster spot. Post-All-Star fatigue management protects the July velocity (97.1 on the 4-seam).

Luzardo

Retrospective credit: the execution gains are his — a full tick of added fastball velocity, a career-grade sweeper (50.9% whiff on 681 first-half sweepers), a June walk spike (10.8% BB) corrected to 4.1% in July, and the best month of his Phillies tenure timed exactly when it counted. **Second-half watch:** the profile now depends on chase. If hitters start taking the sweeper, the 46.8% zone rate needs to come back up — the first-pitch strike rate (60.0%, down from 67.2%) is the early-warning gauge to keep on the dashboard.

§7 — Sustainability & candid caveats

- **The case for sustaining:** the xwOBA (.269) is *better* than the results (.295), hard-hit is down 6.6 points, and the strikeout engine is a pitch-level trait (sweeper whiff), not a sequencing trick. Regression, if anything, points mildly upward.
- **The case for caution:** the whole identity leans on out-of-zone chase (33.3%). League adjustment to the sweeper-first look — especially 2nd time through, where the .368 wOBA says hitters already adjust within games — is the realistic failure mode.
- 2026 is a half-season vs a full 2025; per-start rates are comparable, season totals are not.
- IP from event outs (108.2) and RA9 from on-mound score deltas (3.64) are reconstructions — close to official, not official. **No official ERA/W-L appears in this report because the pitch log cannot compute them.**
- July (49 PA) and Marchán (70 PA) splits are below the 100-BF convention and labeled throughout.
- All-Star selection is user-provided context; artifact receipts: `out/dp_uc17_*.csv`, figures `out/dp_uc17_fig1-3.png`, DQ scorecard PASS (`dp_uc17_dq_scorecard.csv`), freshness manifest (`dp_uc17_freshness_manifest.csv`).